

David Zimmerman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Securities and Exchange Commission, Office of the Investor Advocate
Financial Economist Fellow 2022 - Present

Consumer Financial Protection Bureau
Research Assistant Fellow 2014 – 2017

EDUCATION

PhD, Management (Specialization in Behavioral Decision Making) 2022
Anderson School of Management, University of California, Los Angeles

Bachelor of Science, Decision Sciences (additional major: Statistics) 2014
Carnegie Mellon University

PUBLICATIONS

Chin, Alycia, Carman, Katherine, Craig, Adam, Cook, Jonathan A., and **Zimmerman, David B.** (2026).
“Turning Policy Implications into Policy Impact: Lessons from Behavioral Science in Financial
Markets.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(28), e2525990123

Aczel, Balazs, Szaszi, Barnabas, Clelland Harry T., [incl. **Zimmerman, David**][†]. (2026). “Investigating the
analytical robustness of the social and behavioural sciences.” *Nature*, 1-10.

Zimmerman, David, Chin, Alycia, and Bruine de Bruin, Wändi. (2026) “Question Design Matters: Response
Options Influence the Length of Reported Financial Planning Horizons.” *Journal of Behavioral
Finance*, 1-12.

Bruine de Bruin, Wändi, Chin, Alycia, **Zimmerman, David**, and van der Klaauw, Wilbert. (2025). “Everything
in its own time: Planning Horizons vary across financial domains.” *Journal of Behavioral Decision
Making*, 38(4), e70035.

Zimmerman, David, Spiller, Stephen, Reinholtz, Nicholas, and Maglio, Sam. (2025). “When Metrics Matter:
The Impact of Elicitation Metric on Uncertainty Estimates.” *Cognition*, 265, 106277.

Chin, A., **Zimmerman, D.**, Johnson, H., & Shu, S. B. (2022). “Decisions about overdraft coverage: Disclosure
design and personal finances.” *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied*, 28(4), 746-774.

Warmath, D., & **Zimmerman, D.** (2019). “Financial Literacy as More than Knowledge: The Development of a
Formative Scale through the Lens of Bloom's Domains of Knowledge. *Journal of Consumer Affairs*, 53(4),
1602-1629.

[†]: Team science publication

GOVERNMENT REPORTS

Carman, K., Chin, A., Cook, J., Nash, S. B., Scholl, B., & **Zimmerman, D. B.** (2023). Investor testing report on registered index-linked annuities (OIAD Working Paper 2023-01). Office of the Investor Advocate, Securities and Exchange Commission.

Chin, A., **Zimmerman, D. B.**, Cook, J., Carman, K., Scholl, B., (2024). Investor Testing on Registered Investment Company Fee Meters (OIAD Working Paper 2024-01). Office of the Investor Advocate, Securities and Exchange Commission.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Chin, Alycia, **Zimmerman, David**, Cook, Jonathan, Carman, Katherine, Scholl, Brian. “The benefits of Searching for Alternative Mutual Funds: The Role of Relative Costs in an Information Experiment.” (*Working paper*)

Carman, Katherine, Chin, Alycia, Cook, Jonathan, Nash, Steven B., Scholl, Brian, and **Zimmerman, David B.** “Understanding the performance of registered index-linked annuities.”

Zimmerman, David “Risk Loving, Confused, or Misled? The Mystery of Risk Seeking Choices” *In preparation.*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* Denotes session chair

When Metrics Matter: The Impact of Elicitation Metric on Uncertainty Estimates. With Stephen A. Spiller, Nicholas Reinholtz, and Sam Maglio.

- Special Session* at Association for Consumer Research, Oct 2021.
- Society for Judgment and Decision Making Annual Conference (2021). Poster presentation.

Disclosure Design, Consumer Comprehension, and Decisions about Overdraft Services, with Alycia Chin, Heidi Johnson, and Suzanne Shu.

- Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making (2020). Poster Presentation. Note this conference was cancelled due to Covid-19.
- Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making (2023). Poster Presentation
- American Psychological Association (2023) as part of the panel “Fees, Calories, and Uncertainties: The Psychology of Information Disclosure in Finance, Health, and Law”

The benefits of Searching for Alternative Mutual Funds: The Role of Relative Costs in an Information Experiment. With Alycia Chin, Jonathan Cook, Katherine Carman, and Brian Scholl

- Current Innovations in Probability-Based Household Internet Panel Research CIPHER as part of the panel “Introducing the THRIVE Panel”
- Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making (2025). Poster Presentation

Question Design Matters: Response Options Influence the Length of Reported Financial Time Horizons, with Alycia Chin and Wändi Bruine de Bruin

- Special Session at Association for Consumer Research, Oct 2025.

Turning Policy Implications into Policy Impact: Lessons from Behavioral Science in Financial Markets. With Alycia Chin, Katherine Carman, Jonathan Cook, and Adam Craig

- Special Session at Behavioral Decision Research in Management (2026)

GRANTS

Morrison Center Research Grant 2021-2022, “Understanding How Consumers Incorporate and Estimate Uncertainty” (\$2,450) Co-PI

Morrison Center Research Grant 2020-2021, “Uncertainty of Continuous Outcomes” (\$2,400) Co-PI

NBER Research and Disability Research Center, 2019-2020, “Broad Framing in Retirement Income Decision Making” (\$75,000) Co-PI

SKILLS

Languages: English, R, Python

Tools: OpenAI Codex, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot

Data Collection: Nationally representative surveys, online experiments, field experiments, structured interviews